



FIRST PLACE TO WELCOME THE NEW YEAR

While Sydney, Australia, receives the lion's share of media attention for having one of the first celebrations of the new year, it is Tonga, which is the first country in the world where the New Year dawns. Made up of more than 170 South Pacific islands, the main island is Tongatapu, a coral island with plenty of sandy beaches. Go for snorkelling, island hopping and sea kayaking in the protected lagoon. Oh! and when you see the first dawn of the New Year, don't forget to greet others by saying, "Ofa kemou ma'u ha ta'ufo'ou monu'ia" — Tongan for Happy New Year!



| 81



LAST PLACE TO WELCOME THE NEW YEAR

Just over 500 miles away from Tonga, be among the last to welcome 2024 in American Samoa. Technically, the clock will last strike midnight on Baker Island in the South Pacific. However, Baker Island is uninhabited, so you'll need to celebrate an hour earlier in American Samoa. Charter a flight between Tonga and American Samoa and you can celebrate New Year twice on the same day!